Cyber security checklist for small business

The 20 checks that stop most attacks, in plain English, mapped to the ACSC Essential Eight.

Accounts and sign-in

- [ ] MFA turned on for every email, Microsoft 365 / Google and admin account (E8)
- [ ] Everyday accounts have no admin rights; admins use separate accounts (E8)
- [ ] A business password manager used by every staff member
- [ ] Leavers switched off on their last day, shared passwords changed

Updates and software

- [ ] Apps (browsers, Office, PDF readers) update automatically (E8)
- [ ] Operating systems updated within two weeks; no unsupported versions (E8)
- [ ] Only approved software can run on work computers (E8)
- [ ] Office macros from the internet blocked (E8)
- [ ] Browsers and Office hardened with central security settings (E8)

Backups and recovery

- [ ] Daily backups of important files and systems (E8)
- [ ] At least one backup copy offline or locked so ransomware cannot reach it
- [ ] Microsoft 365 / Google Workspace backed up by a separate service
- [ ] A test restore done in the last three months, and the time it took noted

General guidance only, not formal advice. (E8) = related to the ACSC Essential Eight. (c) MSM Technologies.

Cyber security checklist for small business (continued)

Tick each item as you go. Anything unticked is a conversation worth having.

Devices and network

- [ ] Every laptop and phone with work data is managed, encrypted and wipeable
- [ ] Managed antivirus / EDR on every device, with alerts someone acts on
- [ ] Firewall supported and updated; guest Wi-Fi separate from staff devices

People and plans

- [ ] Short security training for staff at least once a year
- [ ] Everyone knows how to report a suspicious email or call
- [ ] A one-page incident plan, including Notifiable Data Breach steps
- [ ] Payment details changes always confirmed by phone on a known number

Notes and next steps

Who owns each unticked item, and by when?

Not sure about some of these?

Book a free 15-minute call and we will go through your list with you. No obligation.
Call 0449 853 637 or visit msm-technologies.sites.tab.bot/book

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